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Rising With POWER, PURPOSE AND INFLUENCE

Become All You Were CREATED To Be

RISING WITH PURPOSE, POWER AND INFLUENCE

(A Breakdown of the 7 Mountains of Influence)

Teenagers and Young Adults Series

INTRODUCTION

We are living in a time where young people are searching for meaning, direction, and identity. Teenagers and young adults are exposed to different voices every day, from social media, friends, family expectations, and societal pressure. Many are told what to become but are rarely guided on how to discover who they truly are. This book was written to fill that gap.

"Understanding Purpose, Power and Influence" is a spiritual and practical guide created to help young people discover why they exist, what they carry inside them, and how they can shape the world around them. Every life was designed with intention. No teenager is here by accident. No young adult is without a gift. Inside every person is a seed of purpose waiting to be discovered and nurtured.

Purpose gives life direction. Without purpose, people drift, compare themselves endlessly, and struggle with confusion. When purpose is discovered, decisions become clearer, confidence grows, and life gains meaning. Young people who understand purpose early avoid many destructive paths and live with intentionality.

Power is the ability placed within every individual to act, grow, overcome, and influence situations. True power is not about control, fame, or popularity; it is about discipline, spiritual strength, wisdom, and the courage to stand for what is right. Teenagers and young adults must

learn how to channel their energy into growth instead of pressure, fear, or distraction.

Influence is unavoidable. Every young person is influencing someone through words, behavior, online presence, and daily choices. The real question is not whether you are influencing people, but whether your influence is positive or negative. This book will help you become a voice of light, wisdom, and transformation in your generation.

Society itself is shaped by certain systems and structures that determine how people think, live, and relate with one another. These systems are commonly described as the Seven Mountains of Influence: Family, Education, Spirituality, Media, Arts & Culture, Government, and Business. Each of these mountains shapes culture and determines the direction of communities and nations.

Every young person will find themselves connected to one or more of these mountains. Your calling may be to strengthen families, transform education, lead spiritually, create media, shape culture, lead in governance, or build businesses that change lives. Discovering where you belong begins with understanding purpose.

This book is not just meant to be read; it is meant to be experienced. Each chapter is designed to challenge your thinking, strengthen your identity, and awaken your responsibility. You will encounter lessons that push you

to reflect, questions that help you discover yourself, and spiritual insights that guide your growth.

As you read, you will learn to:

- Discover your purpose early
- Understand the power you carry
- Build strong character and identity
- Develop positive influence
- Recognize your role in society
- Prepare to impact your generation

This is more than a book it is a journey. A journey into purpose. A journey into power. A journey into influence. And most importantly, a journey into becoming who you were created to be.

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CHAPTER ONE: DISCOVERING PURPOSE

Let's be honest.

At some point in life, every young person asks questions they don't always say out loud.

"Why am I here?"
"What am I supposed to become?"
"Does my life really matter?"

You may be in school, learning, laughing with friends, scrolling through your phone, and living your normal life… but deep inside, there is a quiet desire to understand your life. You want to know that you are not just existing you are here for a reason.

That reason is called ***purpose.***

Purpose is not just about the job you will do in the future. It is not just about money, fame, or success. Purpose is about meaning. It is about direction. It is about knowing that your life counts for something and that you were created to add value to the world.

Nobody is born empty. Nobody is a mistake. Every young person carries something important inside a gift, an idea, a passion, a burden to help others, or a desire to change something around them.

The problem is that many people grow older without ever discovering it.

You are not here by accident

There is a reason you were born in this generation.
A reason you have your personality.
A reason you think the way you do.
A reason certain things make you happy while other things disturb your heart.

Purpose is usually connected to the things that move you emotionally.

- The problems that make you uncomfortable
- The things you enjoy doing naturally
- The ideas that keep coming to your mind
- The desire to help people in certain areas

These are not random feelings. They are clues.

Many teenagers ignore these clues because they are busy trying to fit in, impress people, or survive pressure from school, family, and society. ***But purpose does not shout; it whispers***. You discover it when you slow down and pay attention to your heart.

Why many young people feel lost

Growing up today is not easy.

There is pressure everywhere.

- Pressure to look a certain way
- Pressure to belong
- Pressure to succeed quickly
- Pressure from social media
- Pressure from comparison
- Sometimes we even express pressure from our Parents

You see people your age doing big things online, and you start wondering if you are behind in life. You start questioning yourself. You start feeling like you are not enough.

But purpose is not a competition.

Life is not a race against your friends. Everyone has a different journey, a different timing, and a different assignment. When you compare your journey with someone else's, you create confusion.

Purpose grows in clarity, not comparison.

Purpose starts with knowing yourself

Before you discover what you are meant to do, you must begin to understand who you are.

Many people try to copy others because they have not taken time to understand themselves. They follow trends, chase popularity, and make decisions based on what everyone else is doing.

But purpose is personal.

Ask yourself simple questions:

- What do I enjoy doing without being forced?
- What kind of problems do I like solving?
- What makes me feel alive and excited?
- What do people naturally come to me for?

Your answers may look small now, but they matter.

Purpose usually starts small before it grows big.

Your gifts are connected to your purpose

Everyone is gifted differently.

Some people are natural leaders.
Some are great listeners.
Some are creative.
Some are problem solvers.
Some are encouragers.

Some are teachers.
Some are builders.

And even many more.

Your gift is not a mistake. It is a pointer. It is showing you the direction of your purpose.

When you begin to use your gift, even in small ways, you start feeling fulfilled. Not because everything is perfect, but because you are functioning the way you were designed to.

A personal story: my journey discovering purpose

Let me share part of my life so you understand that discovering purpose is not always straight or clear.

When I was about five years old, I wanted to become a doctor. It sounded meaningful and important. After some time, I started thinking about becoming a pilot because I was told pilots earn more money. Later, I began to think about the risks involved, and my mind changed again.

Then I told myself I wanted to become a soldier. I had strong passion for anything related to the force. Even while growing up, that passion stayed with me. I joined the Boys' Scout association and I served as the General

Secretary. Leadership and discipline started forming inside me from that stage.

When I got to JSS 3, my mom told me that a prophet said I should study a course related to engineering. Because of that, I moved into the science department. The truth is, I did not really have deep passion for engineering, but I followed the direction given to me.

After secondary school, I studied Computer Engineering for my National Diploma. It was part of the journey, but deep inside, I was still searching. I was still trying to understand where I truly belonged.

Along the line, while learning and growing, I discovered something important I had a strong flair for tech-related courses. It came naturally to me. I understood it faster. I enjoyed it more. That was when I made a bold decision to start again and study Computer Science.

That decision changed my direction.

My story shows that purpose is not always discovered in one day. Sometimes, you try different paths. Sometimes, you follow what people advise. Sometimes, you learn through experience. And sometimes, you have to start again.

There is nothing wrong with that.

Every step, every confusion, every change was part of the process that helped me understand myself better.

Purpose is discovered, not forced

You don’t wake up one morning and suddenly know everything about your life. Purpose is a journey. You discover it step by step.

Through learning.
Through experiences.
Through mistakes.
Through growth.
Through prayer and reflection.
Through helping others.

The more you grow, the clearer your purpose becomes.

You don’t need to have your whole life figured out right now. What matters is that you start paying attention and living intentionally.

Living without purpose is risky

When purpose is unknown, anything can look attractive.

You may follow the wrong friends.
You may build wrong habits.

You may waste time on things that don’t add value.
You may chase validation instead of growth.

But when you understand that your life has direction, you start making better choices.

You become more careful with your time.
You protect your energy.
You choose your friends wisely.
You focus on growth instead of distraction.

Purpose gives you discipline.

Purpose is about impact, not popularity

Many young people think purpose means being famous or known by everyone. That is not true.

Purpose is about impact.

It is about how your life helps others.
It is about the problems you solve.
It is about the lives you touch.
It is about the value you bring.

You don’t have to be loud to be purposeful. You just have to be intentional.

A simple truth to remember

You are still growing.
You are still learning.
You are still becoming.

It is okay not to have all the answers right now. What matters is that you remain open, willing to learn, and ready to grow.

Your purpose will unfold as you grow.

Reflection moment

Pause and think about this:

- What do I love doing naturally?
- What problems do I care about?
- What kind of person do I want to become?
- What do I want my life to stand for?

There are no wrong answers. Just be honest with yourself.

A personal reminder

Your life is important.
Your voice matters.

Your ideas matter.
Your growth matters.

You were created for more than just existing. You were created to live with meaning, grow with intention, and influence your world in a positive way.

This is just the beginning of the journey

CHAPTER TWO: PURPOSE AND IDENTITY

Before you can truly walk in your purpose, you must understand who you are.

Identity is the foundation of everything. The way you see yourself affects how you think, the choices you make, the friends you keep, and the direction your life takes.

Many young people are trying to discover purpose without first understanding identity. That is why confusion happens. When you don't know who you are, you try to become everything at once or copy everyone around you.

Who are you really?

This question sounds simple, but it is deep.

You are not just your name.
You are not just your background.
You are not just your mistakes.
You are not just your school or your results.

You are a person with value. You carry potential. You were designed in a unique way.

There is something about you that no one else has in the same way your thinking, your personality, your strengths, your experiences. All these things form your identity.

When you don't understand this, you start living based on people's opinions instead of your truth.

The danger of comparison

Comparison is one of the biggest struggles among teenagers and young adults today.

You see someone doing better in school, you feel small.
You see someone looking better, you feel insecure.
You see someone succeeding online, you feel behind in life.

Little by little, you start doubting yourself.

But comparison steals identity.

You were not created to be a copy. You were created to be original. The moment you start measuring your life against everyone else, you lose sight of what makes you unique.

Your journey is different.
Your timing is different.
Your growth is different.

And that is okay.

Identity builds confidence

Confidence is not noise or pride. It is not about showing off. Confidence is simply knowing who you are and being comfortable with it.

When you understand yourself:

- You stop seeking validation from everyone
- You make decisions with clarity
- You are not easily pressured
- You stand for what you believe in

Identity gives you stability.

Without identity, every opinion shakes you. Every criticism breaks you. Every trend pulls you in a different direction.

You are still becoming

One mistake many young people make is thinking they must have everything figured out immediately.

Life does not work that way.

Identity grows.

You learn about yourself through:

- experiences
- friendships
- mistakes
- learning
- spiritual growth

There are things you will understand about yourself at 25 that you didn't understand at 15. Growth reveals identity step by step.

So don't rush the process.

Labels can be dangerous

Sometimes people label you.

"You are not smart."
"You are too quiet."
"You are stubborn."
"You can't succeed."

If you accept those words, they begin to shape how you see yourself.

But your identity should not be built on what people say. It should be built on truth, growth, and self-awareness.

You are allowed to grow beyond people's expectations.

Identity and purpose are connected

Purpose flows from identity.

When you know who you are:

- You know what fits you
- You know what doesn't
- You choose paths that align with your strengths
- You avoid distractions that don't match your direction

Identity helps you stay focused.

It reminds you that you don't have to follow every trend, every opportunity, or every voice.

Building a strong identity

Here are simple ways to start:

1. Spend time understanding yourself
   Notice what you enjoy, what drains you, and what excites you.

2. Accept your uniqueness
   You don’t have to look, talk, or act like everyone else.
3. Develop your strengths
   Focus on what you are naturally good at and grow it.
4. Work on your weaknesses
   Growth is part of identity. Nobody is perfect.
5. Stay spiritually grounded
   Your relationship with God helps you understand your worth beyond people’s opinions.

Reflection moment

Pause and think honestly:

- How do I see myself?
- Do I believe my life has value?
- What makes me different from others?
- Where do I need to grow?

Be honest. There are no wrong answers.

A reminder for you

You don’t need to pretend.
You don’t need to force yourself to fit in.
You don’t need to become someone else to be accepted.

You are allowed to grow into yourself.

Identity is not discovered overnight. But the moment you begin to understand who you are, your purpose becomes clearer and your confidence becomes stronger.

And once identity is forming, the next thing you must understand is power the strength inside you that helps you stand, grow, and influence your world.

CHAPTER THREE: UNDERSTANDING POWER

When many people hear the word ***power***, their minds quickly go to things like money, fame, authority, or control. They imagine powerful people as those who can command others, make decisions for everyone, or live above normal rules. But the truth is, real power is deeper than all of that. Real power begins from within.

Power is the strength inside you that helps you stand when life is hard, stay focused when others are distracted, and keep growing even when no one is clapping for you. It is the ability to control your thoughts, your emotions, your choices, and your direction. Power is not about controlling people; it is about mastering yourself.

Every teenager and young adult already carries power, whether they realize it or not. The ability to think, to choose, to learn, to change, to resist pressure, and to become better is power. But many people never develop it. Some ignore it. Some misuse it. Some allow fear and distraction to weaken it. Understanding your power is the beginning of using it correctly.

Power starts from inside before it ever shows outside. You don't suddenly become powerful because people recognize you. You become powerful when you learn to discipline yourself, manage your emotions, stay focused on growth, and remain committed to what matters. A young

person who can say no to bad influence is powerful. A student who keeps studying even when it is hard is powerful. Someone who controls anger instead of reacting is powerful. These are quiet forms of power, but they shape your life more than any public recognition.

Mental power is one of the first strengths every young person must develop. Your mind is where everything begins. The way you think affects the way you live. If your mind is constantly filled with fear, doubt, comparison, and negativity, your life will reflect confusion and insecurity. But when you train your mind to think clearly, to focus on solutions, and to learn from experiences, you begin to grow in strength. Mental power helps you solve problems, stay focused in school, make better decisions, and avoid being easily influenced by what everyone else is doing.

Emotional power is another important strength. Life will not always go the way you expect. People will disappoint you. Plans will fail. You will face rejection, pressure, and moments of frustration. Emotional power is the ability to stay calm in those moments. It is choosing not to react out of anger, fear, or jealousy. It is learning to pause, think, and respond wisely. Many people lose opportunities not because they are not talented, but because they cannot manage their emotions. A person who understands their emotions but is not controlled by them is strong.

Discipline is one of the highest forms of power. Discipline is not punishment; it is self-control. It is doing what is right even when you don’t feel like it. It is waking up to study when others are sleeping, practicing a skill when others are wasting time, staying committed when motivation is low, and making decisions that support your future instead of your comfort. Discipline may not look exciting, but it is what separates people who grow from those who remain stagnant. Talent can open doors, but discipline keeps those doors open.

CHAPTER FOUR: UNDERSTANDING INFLUENCE

Many young people think influence is only for famous people, pastors, politicians, celebrities, or people with large followers online. But influence starts long before the crowd comes. Influence begins from the moment your life begins to affect another person's life.

Influence is not noise. It is impact.

You are influential when people listen to you.
You are influential when your decisions affect others.
You are influential when your character speaks louder than your words.

Even a teenager has influence. In fact, many destinies are shaped during teenage years because that is when identity is formed and direction begins.

Influence is not about control. It is about responsibility.

Some people think influence means making people do what you want. That is manipulation. True influence is when people are inspired, not forced. It is when your life makes others want to become better.

You influence your friends by the choices you make.
You influence your siblings by the way you behave.
You influence your classmates by what you stand for.

Whether you know it or not, someone is always watching you.

That is why influence must be understood early in life. If you don't understand it, you may misuse it. And if you misuse influence, you can damage lives without even realizing it.

Influence grows from three main things: character, consistency, and connection.

Character is who you are when nobody is watching. People may not see everything, but they can feel what is real. A young person who is honest, respectful, and disciplined naturally attracts trust. And where there is trust, influence begins.

Consistency is what makes influence stay. Anybody can do something good once. But when your life shows the same values again and again, people begin to rely on you. They know you are stable. They know you are dependable. And that gives your voice weight.

Connection is what spreads influence. You cannot influence people you avoid. You cannot impact people you refuse to understand. Influence grows in relationships — at home, in school, in church, in community, even online.

Influence is not loud. It is steady.

There are different types of influence, and every young person will naturally lean toward one or more.

There is leadership influence when people look up to you for direction.
There is knowledge influence when people come to you because you understand things.
There is emotional influence when your presence comforts people.
There is spiritual influence when your life points people closer to God.

You don't need to force any of these. As you grow, one will begin to show.

But there is also a dangerous side of influence.

Influence can be used wrongly.

A student can influence friends into bad habits.
A young person can influence others into disrespecting authority.
Social media can influence values without people realizing it.

This is why influence without purpose is risky.

When you don't know why you exist, your influence can scatter people instead of guiding them. But when purpose is clear, influence becomes intentional.

You begin to ask:
What do I want my life to represent?
What should people learn from me?
What kind of impact should follow me?

Influence is not built in one day. It grows from daily decisions.

The way you talk.
The way you dress.
The way you respond to pressure.
The way you treat people who cannot help you.

All these things are building your influence quietly.

Many teenagers are waiting to “blow” before they start thinking about influence. But influence starts before visibility. Long before the platform comes, your habits are already shaping your voice.

Your influence in the future is being prepared by your life now.

There is also something important every young person must understand: influence flows from identity.

If you don’t know who you are, you will copy others.
If you copy others, your influence will not be stable.
And if your influence is not stable, people will not trust it.

You must first become comfortable with who you are — your strengths, your weaknesses, your journey, your growth. Real influence comes from authenticity. People connect with what is real, not what is perfect.

Another truth is this: influence attracts responsibility.

The moment people start listening to you, your life is no longer just about you. Your words can build or break. Your actions can encourage or discourage. Your silence can even confuse.

That is why influence must be handled with humility.

Never think you are better than others because they listen to you. Influence is not a crown; it is a tool. And every tool must be used carefully.

Also, influence does not mean you know everything. You will still make mistakes. You will still learn. You will still grow. But what matters is your willingness to stay teachable.

The most dangerous influential people are those who stop learning.

As a young person, your influence may look small now. Maybe it is just among your friends. Maybe it is within your family. Maybe it is in your classroom. But never despise small influence. That is where the foundation is built.

A tree that will grow tall must first be stable in the soil.

One day, your influence will expand into the mountains of society education, family, media, government, business, religion, arts and entertainment. But before that happens, your influence must be tested in small spaces.

Can you influence peace instead of conflict?
Can you influence honesty instead of shortcuts?
Can you influence focus instead of distraction?

These small moments prepare you for larger impact.

There is also a spiritual side to influence.

God gives influence to people who are available and responsible. Not just talented people, but faithful people. Not just loud people, but committed people.

Influence becomes powerful when your life aligns with something bigger than yourself. When your actions are not just for attention, but for purpose. When your decisions are not just for gain, but for impact.

At that point, influence stops being about popularity and starts becoming about legacy.

Legacy is what remains after you leave a place.
Legacy is what people remember about your life.
Legacy is the seed your influence leaves behind.

Teenagers and young adults must start thinking about legacy early. Not in a heavy way, but in a conscious way.

What will my life stand for?
What difference will I make?
Who will be better because I lived?

These questions guide influence in the right direction.

Influence is not reserved for tomorrow. It begins today.

The way you respond when you are angry.
The way you act when nobody corrects you.
The way you handle freedom.
The way you respect people.

All these moments are shaping your influence.

And the truth is simple: you cannot stop influencing people. You are either influencing them positively or negatively.

So the real question is not, “Do I have influence?”

The real question is, “What kind of influence am I carrying?”

Because whether you know it or not, someone is learning from your life. Spiritual power gives direction to every other kind of power. Your connection with God strengthens your inner life. It gives you peace when you feel confused, courage when you feel weak, and wisdom when you must make decisions. Spiritual growth helps you build values, character, and conviction. It reminds you that your life has meaning beyond what people see on the outside. When your spiritual life is growing, you are not easily shaken by pressure because you are rooted in something deeper than trends and opinions.

It is important to understand that power can be used wrongly. Some people use their intelligence to manipulate others. Some use their influence to lead people into negative lifestyles. Some use their strength to intimidate and control. That is not true power; it is misuse of strength. Real power builds people, supports growth, protects what is right, and brings positive change. If your strength is hurting others, then it is not purpose-driven.

Many young people feel weak because they focus too much on what they don’t have. They think power only belongs to those with money, connections, or opportunities. But power is not measured by what you have; it is measured by how you grow with what you have. The ability to learn is power. The willingness to start again is power. The courage to

say “I will do better” is power. The decision to keep moving forward when life is hard is power.

Power does not grow in comfort. It grows through challenges. Difficult classes build mental strength. Rejection builds emotional strength. Responsibility builds discipline. Spiritual struggles build faith. Every challenge you face is shaping something inside you. Instead of always asking, “Why is this happening to me?” begin to ask, “What is this building inside me?” That question changes your perspective and helps you grow instead of giving up.

Another important truth is that power must be guided. If strength is not guided, it can lead to pride, impatience, and wrong decisions. Some young people become strong but not wise. They become bold but not disciplined. They become confident but not teachable. True power remains humble. It keeps learning. It listens. It grows. It understands that strength is a responsibility, not just an advantage.

Power is also meant to be used for others, not just for yourself. You grow stronger so you can help someone who is struggling. You learn so you can guide someone who is confused. You develop discipline so you can become an example. You grow spiritually so you can bring light into dark situations. The more your strength begins to help others, the more meaningful your life becomes.

There is power in your voice. There is power in your choices. There is power in your habits. There is power in your consistency. Many young people underestimate themselves because they are waiting for a big moment, but power is built in everyday decisions. The choice to read instead of scrolling endlessly. The choice to pray instead of worrying. The choice to apologize instead of holding pride. The choice to try again instead of quitting. These small decisions shape your strength.

You must also understand that power grows with time. You may not feel strong today, but growth is a process. Every lesson you learn, every mistake you correct, every habit you build, and every step you take is adding to your strength. One day, you will look back and realize you are no longer the person you used to be.

Pause and ask yourself some honest questions. Where am I strong right now? Where do I struggle the most? Do I control my emotions or do they control me? Am I disciplined with my time and choices? Am I growing spiritually or just living casually? These questions are not meant to make you feel bad. They are meant to help you become aware. Awareness is the beginning of growth.

Never forget this: you are not powerless. You are not empty. You are not weak. Inside you is strength you have not even fully discovered yet. Strength to learn, to change, to rise again, to stand for what is right, and to influence your world positively.

But power alone is not enough. Power must be directed. Power must be used. Power must reach people and affect lives. And that is where influence comes in.

One thing many young people don’t realize is that power attracts responsibility. The moment you begin to grow in knowledge, discipline, or influence people start watching you. Your younger ones observe you. Your friends listen to you. Your decisions begin to affect others. That is why power must be handled carefully.

If a person grows in strength but not in character, that strength can destroy them. Intelligence without character can lead to manipulation. Confidence without discipline can lead to pride. Influence without values can lead to damage. Real power must grow alongside character.

Character is what guides power. It is what tells you when to speak and when to stay silent. It is what helps you stay honest when lying would be easier. It is what keeps you grounded when success starts coming. Character protects your future.

Another important part of understanding power is learning how to protect your energy. Not everything deserves your attention. Not every argument deserves your response. Not every trend deserves your participation.
When you understand your power, you begin to guard your time, your mind, and your environment.

Some friendships drain you.
Some habits weaken you.
Some environments slow your growth.

Power grows when you surround yourself with what strengthens you good mentors, positive friends, learning opportunities, and spiritual guidance. Where you stay affects who you become.

You must also learn that power is built in private before it is seen in public. The discipline nobody sees, the studying nobody praises, the prayers nobody hears, the effort nobody notices these are the things building your strength. Public results are usually the outcome of private commitment.

Many people want to look strong outside, but they are weak inside. They chase appearance instead of growth. But real strength is quiet. It is steady. It grows over time and reveals itself when challenges come.

Power also requires patience. Growth takes time. Skills take time. Maturity takes time. You cannot rush strength. A tree does not become strong overnight. It grows slowly, develops deep roots, and stands firm over time. Your life is the same. Every day you grow, you are developing roots.

There will be days you feel tired. Days you feel confused. Days you feel like you are not making progress. That does not mean you are weak. It

means you are human. Strength is not the absence of struggle; it is the decision to keep going despite the struggle.

It is also important to know that power is connected to purpose. When you begin to understand why you are here, your strength becomes more focused. You stop wasting energy on things that don't matter. You stop trying to impress everyone. You stop chasing everything. You begin to move with direction.

Purpose gives your power assignment.

Without purpose, power can be scattered. With purpose, power becomes impactful.

Another truth is that everyone's power will look different. Some people are powerful with words. Some with ideas, Some with leadership, Some with compassion, Some with creativity, Some with discipline. You don't need to have someone else's strength to be powerful. Your strength is valid.

Stop measuring your strength with someone else's gift.

Develop what you carry.

There is also power in consistency. Not motivation. Not excitement. Consistency. Showing up daily. Learning daily. Growing daily. Improving daily. Small daily growth leads to big long-term results. Many

people are waiting for one big moment, but power grows through small daily commitments.

You read a little every day.
You pray a little every day.
You practice a skill every day.
You correct a habit every day.

That is how strength builds.

Another side of power is learning when to rest. Many young people think strength means always pushing, always working, always trying to prove something. But even strength needs renewal. Rest helps your mind reset, your emotions heal, and your focus return. Knowing when to pause is also wisdom.

You must also forgive yourself when you make mistakes. Growth is not perfect. You will fail sometimes. You will make wrong decisions sometimes. You will learn lessons the hard way sometimes. That does not cancel your strength. It is part of building it. Every mistake you learn from adds to your maturity.

As you continue to grow, you will begin to notice something your thinking changes. Your choices become wiser. You react differently to situations. Things that used to distract you no longer control you. That is power developing.

You become less controlled by pressure.
Less controlled by opinions.
Less controlled by fear.

You begin to live with intention.

And when power grows in the right way, influence naturally follows. People start learning from you without you trying too hard. Your life becomes a message. Your growth becomes an encouragement to others.

This is why understanding power is so important at a young age. If you learn it early, you avoid many mistakes. You become more focused. You grow faster. You make better decisions. You protect your future.

Let this truth stay with you:

You are not too young to be strong.
You are not too young to be disciplined.
You are not too young to grow spiritually.
You are not too young to influence your world.

Strength is not about age. It is about awareness and growth.

And now that you understand power what it is, how it grows, and how to protect it the next thing you must learn is how to use it to affect others positively.

Because power that does not reach others becomes incomplete.

That is where influence comes in.

CHAPTER FIVE: THE MOUNTAIN OF FAMILY

Family Is the First Place of Influence

Family is the first place where purpose, power, and influence begin to grow. Before school, before church, before society, before the world even knows your name family is the environment that shapes your life first. It is where values are formed, where identity begins, and where character quietly develops.

Whether a family is strong or struggling, present or distant, it still plays a major role in shaping a young person's thinking and direction. Many teenagers don't realize that family is one of the most powerful mountains of influence in the world. Governments rise and fall, trends come and go, but family remains the foundation of society. When families are strong, society becomes stable. When families are broken, society begins to shake.

Understanding this mountain early in life is very important because it affects how you see yourself, how you relate with people, and how you make decisions.

You Are Not Just a Product of Your Family

Family influence does not only come from parents. It comes from siblings, relatives, guardians, and even the atmosphere of the home. The words spoken at home, the habits practiced, the way conflict is handled, and the way love is expressed all shape a young mind.

But there is something many young people don't realize: you are not just a product of your family, you are also a contributor to it. Your attitude affects your home. Your behavior affects your siblings. The way you respond to correction affects the atmosphere around you.

Even as a teenager, you carry influence within your family. You don't have to wait until adulthood before your actions matter. The way you speak, the way you help, and the way you take responsibility all shape peace or tension at home.

Family Can Guide Purpose

Sometimes, family becomes the first place where purpose is noticed. Parents see strengths. Siblings notice gifts. Relatives observe patterns. A young person may not clearly understand what they carry, but family often sees it first.

However, family can also be a place of confusion. Expectations can sometimes replace discovery. A young person may hear statements like, "Follow this path," or "Be like this person." While guidance is important, pressure can hide purpose.

Not every path fits every person. Not every expectation aligns with destiny. This is why a young person must learn to listen respectfully but still discover personally. Family should guide, not control. Support, not suppress. Build, not break.

No Family Is Perfect

Every home has its own struggles. Misunderstandings happen. Communication fails. Emotions rise. Expectations clash. This does not mean the family is bad; it simply means people are growing together.

Teenagers often expect their parents to understand everything, while parents also expect their children to behave perfectly. But growth requires patience on both sides. Understanding begins when we realize that parents are also learning, and children are also becoming.

A healthy family is not a perfect family. It is a family that keeps trying, keeps learning, and keeps growing together.

Communication Builds Strong Homes

Family influence grows stronger when there is communication. Talking, listening, explaining, and understanding help relationships grow. Not shouting, not avoiding, and not assuming.

Many homes struggle not because there is no love, but because there is no communication. People live in the same house but carry different emotions. They share space but do not share understanding.

A young person who learns how to communicate respectfully builds influence at home. When you speak with wisdom instead of anger, your voice begins to carry weight.

Respect and Responsibility

Respect is a powerful pillar in every family. Respect is not fear; it is recognition. Recognizing the sacrifices of parents, recognizing the role of elders, and recognizing that guidance often comes from experience.

At the same time, respect must flow both ways. Teenagers also need to be heard. Their thoughts matter. Their struggles are real. Their questions are valid. A home becomes healthier when everyone feels seen and valued.

Responsibility is another major part of family influence. Simple responsibilities at home build maturity and discipline. Helping out, managing time, being accountable, and caring for others prepare a young person for life beyond the home.

A person who avoids responsibility at home may struggle with responsibility in society.

Emotional and Spiritual Growth Begins at Home

Family is where emotional strength is formed. It is where forgiveness is learned, where patience is tested, and where understanding grows. Conflicts teach lessons about people. Apologies teach humility. Reconciliation teaches love.

Many of these lessons cannot be taught in classrooms. They are lived daily within the home.

There is also a spiritual dimension to family influence. The prayers heard at home, the faith practiced by parents, and the way challenges are handled plant seeds in a young heart. Even when a teenager does not fully understand, those seeds remain.

In moments of confusion or crisis, they begin to grow.

Generational Influence

Families pass things down from one generation to another. Some pass down discipline. Some pass down faith. Some pass down resilience. Others pass down fear or unhealthy habits.

Every family transfers something.

The question every young person must ask is: what am I receiving, and what will I continue?

Instead of only focusing on what your family lacks, also recognize what your family has given you. Strength, values, lessons, and opportunities all play a role in shaping your future. Even challenges build resilience that prepares you for life.

Preparing for the Future

You may not choose the family you were born into, but you can choose the kind of family you will build in the future. The way you treat people now prepares you for the relationships you will form later. The respect you show now shapes how you will be respected later. The patience you learn now prepares you for future responsibilities.

Family is not just your past; it is your training ground for the future.

This mountain teaches identity. It helps you understand where you come from and gives you a sense of belonging. Identity brings stability. When a young person understands their roots, it becomes easier to walk confidently into the future.

Even if your family story is not perfect, your future story can be different. Growth allows you to build on strengths and correct weaknesses. You are shaped by your background, but you are not limited by it.

The Foundation for Greater Influence

As teenagers and young adults grow, they must begin to see family not just as a place of rules, but as a place of preparation. Preparation for relationships, preparation for leadership, and preparation for responsibility.

The home trains you for society.

If you learn patience at home, you will handle people better outside. If you learn respect at home, authority will not intimidate you outside. If you learn communication at home, relationships will grow healthier outside.

Family is the first mountain, and it is foundational. Before influencing the world, you must learn to function within the home. Before leading strangers, you must understand relationships. Before carrying public responsibility, you must learn private discipline.

Even when family feels difficult, never forget: growth often begins in uncomfortable places. This mountain is not just where you were raised it is where your influence first learned how to walk.

CHAPTER SIX: THE MOUNTAIN OF EDUCATION

Education is one of the strongest mountains of influence in the life of any young person. It shapes how you think, how you reason, how you see opportunities, and how you understand the world around you. Long before a person steps into leadership, business, ministry, or any major space in life, education has already started preparing the mind.

For teenagers and young adults, education is not just about passing exams or moving from one class to another. It is about building the mind that will carry your purpose. It is about training yourself to think clearly, solve problems, communicate ideas, and understand life from a deeper perspective.

Many people see education as a requirement, but it is actually a tool. And like every tool, it can be used wisely or carelessly.

Education Shapes the Mind

The mind is one of the greatest gifts a person has. Everything begins from the mind ideas, decisions, creativity, discipline, and even confidence. Education trains the mind to think beyond the surface. It exposes you to knowledge, possibilities, and perspectives you may never encounter on your own.

When a young person begins to learn intentionally, they start seeing life differently. They ask better questions. They become curious. They start understanding how things work and why things happen.

Education does not only give information; it builds understanding.

This is why two people can sit in the same class and still grow differently. One may only aim to pass, while the other aims to learn. The one who learns carries something deeper than grades — they carry insight.

Beyond the Classroom

True education goes beyond the classroom. School is important, but education is bigger than school. It includes what you read, what you observe, what you practice, what you experience, and what you learn from people.

A curious mind is always learning.

Learning from books.
Learning from mentors.
Learning from mistakes.
Learning from conversations.
Learning from life itself.

Some of the most important lessons a young person will learn are not written in textbooks. They are learned through experiences, responsibilities, and personal growth.

Education is not a season; it is a lifestyle.

Discovering Strengths Through Learning

Education also helps a young person discover strengths and interests. As you learn different subjects and skills, you begin to notice what attracts you and what drains you. You start recognizing areas where your mind comes alive.

Some discover love for numbers.
Some discover love for technology.
Some discover love for creativity.
Some discover love for communication.

These discoveries are not small. They are clues pointing toward purpose.

But discovery requires patience. Not everything will make sense immediately. Sometimes, a person studies something for years before realizing the direction they truly want to take. And that is okay.

Growth is a process, not a race.

Discipline and Responsibility

Education teaches discipline. Waking up early, attending classes, meeting deadlines, studying consistently, and preparing for exams all train a young person to become responsible.

Discipline is not always comfortable, but it is necessary. It prepares you for the demands of life. It teaches you how to stay focused even when you feel tired, distracted, or discouraged.

A young person who learns discipline in education will carry that discipline into other areas of life — work, relationships, purpose, and leadership.

Education trains you to finish what you start.

The Role of Teachers and Mentors

Teachers and mentors play a major role in this mountain. Sometimes, one word of encouragement from a teacher can change a student's confidence. Sometimes, one correction can redirect a student's future.

Education is not just about subjects; it is about guidance.

A good teacher does more than teach lessons. They help shape thinking. They challenge laziness. They encourage effort. They help students see possibilities within themselves.

Mentors also play a powerful role. They provide direction based on experience. They help young people avoid mistakes and grow faster. Learning from people who have walked ahead saves time and builds wisdom.

Education and Identity

Education also shapes identity. It helps a young person understand their place in the world. It exposes them to different cultures, ideas, and systems. It helps them understand that the world is bigger than their immediate environment.

This exposure builds confidence. It helps a young person realize they have something to offer. It helps them see that their voice matters.

When knowledge increases, confidence grows.

But education must not lead to pride. Knowledge should build humility, not arrogance. The more you learn, the more you realize how much there is still to learn.

Overcoming Educational Challenges

Not every educational journey is smooth. Some young people struggle with subjects. Some face financial limitations. Some lack encouragement. Some feel pressure. Some even doubt themselves.

These struggles are real, but they do not define your future.

Challenges in education build resilience. They teach perseverance. They train you to keep moving even when things are difficult.

Sometimes, the students who struggle the most become the strongest later because they learn how to fight for growth.

Education is not about being the best; it is about becoming better.

The Danger of Learning Without Purpose

Education without purpose can become stressful. A young person may study hard but feel empty because they do not understand why they are learning.

When purpose is connected to education, learning becomes meaningful. It stops being just about passing exams and becomes about preparation for impact.

You begin to ask:
How will this knowledge help me serve others?
How will it improve my life?
How will it solve problems?

At that point, education becomes intentional.

Technology and Modern Learning

This generation has access to learning tools like never before. Information is everywhere. Skills can be learned online. Ideas can be shared instantly. Opportunities to grow are closer than ever.

But access also comes with responsibility.

Technology can build knowledge or waste time. It can sharpen the mind or distract it. It can open doors or create confusion.

A young person must learn how to use technology wisely. Not everything online adds value. Discipline is needed to choose growth over distraction.

Education as Preparation for Influence

Education prepares you for influence in society. It equips you with knowledge to solve problems, ideas to create change, and confidence to lead conversations.

Every field in society medicine, business, government, media, technology, arts is influenced by education. Those who understand deeply often shape direction.

Education gives your voice credibility.

When knowledge meets purpose, influence becomes powerful.

Learning Never Ends

One of the greatest truths every young person must understand is that education does not end after school. Graduation is not the end of learning; it is the beginning of responsibility.

Life will keep teaching.

Work will teach.
People will teach.
Mistakes will teach.
Success will teach.

A person who stops learning stops growing.

The world keeps changing, and only those who keep learning remain relevant.

Building a Mind That Carries Purpose

Education is not just about filling the head with facts. It is about building a mind that can carry purpose. A mind that can think clearly, decide wisely, create solutions, and stand strong in difficult moments.

The mind you build now will carry the life you live later.

If you train your mind to be lazy, life will feel heavy.
If you train your mind to be disciplined, life will become meaningful.
If you train your mind to be curious, growth will become natural.

Everything begins from how you learn.

A Mountain That Opens Doors

Education opens doors that effort alone cannot open. It connects you to opportunities, people, and environments that shape your future. It gives you language to express ideas and understanding to navigate life.

But education must be embraced with the right mindset.

Not as pressure.
Not as punishment.
But as preparation.

Preparation for purpose.
Preparation for influence.
Preparation for life.

For every teenager and young adult, this mountain is a training ground. It is shaping how you think, how you respond to challenges, and how you prepare for your future role in society.

Education is not just what you study. It is what you become while learning.

And the person you are becoming will determine how far your purpose, power, and influence will go.

CHAPTER SEVEN: THE MOUNTAIN OF FAITH AND SPIRITUALITY

Faith is one of the most powerful forces shaping the life of a young person, even when it is not fully understood. It influences decisions, shapes values, builds character, and provides direction in moments when life feels confusing. The mountain of faith is not just about religion, church attendance, or spiritual activities. It is about connection — connection with God, connection with purpose, and connection with truth.

For teenagers and young adults, this mountain is extremely important because it helps answer the deepest questions of life. Questions like: Why am I here? What is my purpose? Who am I becoming? Where am I going? These questions cannot be answered by education alone, by family alone, or by success alone. They require spiritual understanding.

Faith gives life meaning beyond achievements. It reminds a young person that life is not just about surviving, competing, or proving a point. It is about becoming who you were created to be.

The Search for Meaning

Every young person, at some point, begins to search for meaning. It may not always look spiritual at first. Sometimes it shows up as curiosity, sometimes as confusion, sometimes as restlessness. You may feel like

there must be more to life than just school, social media, friends, and daily routines.

That feeling is not strange. It is the soul searching for direction.

Faith provides answers that the world cannot give. It explains purpose beyond popularity. It explains identity beyond appearance. It explains success beyond money.

Without faith, life can feel empty even when things are going well. But with faith, life begins to feel guided, even when things are uncertain.

Spiritual Foundations Begin Early

Many young people are introduced to faith through their families. Through prayers at home, religious gatherings, teachings, or spiritual conversations. These early exposures plant seeds. Even when a teenager does not fully understand them, they remain in the heart.

As growth continues, those seeds begin to make sense.

Faith grows through exposure, but it becomes personal through experience. At some point, a young person must move from “this is what I was taught” to “this is what I believe.”

That shift is powerful. It marks the beginning of personal spiritual growth.

Faith Builds Identity

One of the strongest gifts faith gives is identity. It reminds a young person that they are not an accident. They are created with intention. Their life has meaning. Their journey has direction.

When identity is rooted in faith, confidence grows. Not the loud confidence that seeks attention, but a quiet confidence that comes from knowing who you are and whose you are.

This kind of identity protects young people from comparison. It protects them from pressure. It protects them from trying to live like everyone else.

Faith stabilizes the heart.

Guidance in a Confusing World

The world is full of voices. Social media, friends, trends, expectations, and opinions constantly try to shape how young people think and live. Without spiritual guidance, it becomes easy to get lost in all the noise.

Faith provides direction. It helps a young person pause, reflect, and make decisions from a place of wisdom instead of pressure.

It teaches discernment — the ability to know what is right, what is wrong, what is helpful, and what is harmful.

This is especially important during teenage and young adult years, when identity is still forming and decisions begin to carry long-term consequences.

Character and Inner Strength

Faith shapes character deeply. It teaches honesty when lying seems easier. It teaches patience when anger feels natural. It teaches humility when pride tries to rise. It teaches forgiveness when hurt feels heavy.

These are not small lessons. They are life-shaping.

A young person grounded in faith develops inner strength. Not strength that comes from physical power, but strength that comes from conviction. Strength that says, “Even if everyone is doing it, I will stand for what is right.”

That kind of strength builds influence and respect.

Prayer and Personal Reflection

One of the most powerful habits a young person can develop is the habit of prayer and reflection. Prayer is not just about asking for things. It is about connection. It is about opening your heart, expressing your fears, your hopes, your questions, and your gratitude.

Reflection helps you understand your journey. It helps you learn from mistakes. It helps you recognize growth. It helps you stay aware of who you are becoming.

In moments of confusion, prayer brings calm. In moments of success, prayer brings humility. In moments of fear, prayer brings courage.

Faith keeps the heart steady.

Spiritual Growth Is a Process

Spiritual maturity does not happen overnight. It grows gradually. Through time, through experiences, through questions, and through personal encounters with life.

There will be moments of doubt. Moments of confusion. Moments where faith feels distant. This is part of growth.

Growth does not mean never struggling. Growth means continuing to seek truth even when you do not understand everything.

Faith becomes stronger when it is tested and still stands.

Faith and Purpose

Purpose and faith are deeply connected. Faith helps a young person discover why they exist. It helps them see their gifts as tools for impact, not just personal gain.

When purpose is rooted in faith, life becomes intentional.

You begin to ask:
How can my life faith help others?
How can my gifts serve people?
How can my decisions reflect who I believe God is calling me to be?

At that point, purpose stops being about self and starts becoming about service.

Influence Through Spiritual Living

Young people often think influence comes from popularity, followers, or public recognition. But spiritual influence is different. It comes from the life you live.

People notice kindness.
People notice discipline.
People notice humility.
People notice integrity.

You may not preach, but your life will speak.

Spiritual influence is quiet but powerful. It changes environments. It encourages others. It brings peace where there is tension.

A young person grounded in faith becomes a light, even without trying.

Avoiding Extremes

There is something important to understand: faith should not become pressure or performance. It is not about pretending to be perfect. It is not about judging others. It is not about forcing beliefs on people.

True faith transforms from within. It grows naturally and reflects in actions.

Balance is important. Spiritual growth must walk hand in hand with emotional growth, mental growth, and social growth. Faith should make a person more compassionate, more understanding, and more patient — not harsh or disconnected.

Faith in Difficult Seasons

Life will not always be smooth. There will be moments of disappointment, failure, loss, and confusion. During these seasons, faith becomes an anchor.

It reminds you that setbacks are not the end.
It reminds you that mistakes can be corrected.
It reminds you that growth often comes through struggle.

Faith helps a young person keep moving even when the path is unclear.

Community and Spiritual Support

Spiritual growth does not happen alone. Community matters. Friends who share values, mentors who guide, and spiritual environments that encourage growth all play a role.

When a young person surrounds themselves with people who build their faith, it becomes easier to stay focused. It becomes easier to stay grounded.

Isolation weakens growth. Community strengthens it.

Living What You Believe

The true test of faith is not what you say; it is how you live. Faith must reflect in daily life in school, at home, among friends, online, and in private moments.

It shows in honesty when nobody is watching.
It shows in kindness when nobody expects it.
It shows in discipline when distractions are many.

Living what you believe builds authenticity. And authenticity builds trust.

A Foundation for Lifelong Direction

The mountain of faith prepares a young person for life. It builds a foundation that remains steady even when everything else changes. Education may shape the mind. Family may shape early life. Society may shape opportunities. But faith shapes the soul.

And the soul is where purpose, power, and influence draw their deepest strength.

When a young person grows spiritually, they become grounded. They are not easily shaken by trends, pressure, or comparison. They move with direction. They live with intention. They grow with purpose.

Faith becomes their compass.

It reminds them who they are.
It reminds them where they are going.
It reminds them that their life is not random it is meaningful, guided, and capable of making impact.

This mountain is not just about religion. It is about relationship, transformation, and direction.

And for every teenager and young adult, understanding faith early in life builds a strength that will carry them through every other mountain they will encounter.

CHAPTER EIGHT: THE MOUNTAIN OF MEDIA AND INFORMATION

The mountain of media is one of the most powerful forces shaping the minds of teenagers and young adults today. In previous generations, influence came mostly from family, school, and community. But in this generation, media has become a daily voice constant, loud, and everywhere.

Through phones, television, music, movies, social platforms, and online content, young people are exposed to ideas, values, lifestyles, and opinions every single day. Media does not just entertain; it shapes thinking. It shapes desires. It shapes identity. It shapes what people see as normal.

Whether we admit it or not, media teaches.

It teaches how to talk.
It teaches how to dress.
It teaches what to admire.
It teaches what to reject.
It even teaches what success should look like.

This is why understanding this mountain is very important for every young person. If you do not understand media, it will shape you without your permission.

Media Is Not Just Entertainment

Many teenagers see media as something harmless just fun, just trends, just something to pass time. But media is more than entertainment. It is influence in motion.

Every video carries a message.
Every song carries a message.
Every post carries a message.

Sometimes the message is positive. Sometimes it is misleading. Sometimes it is subtle. But it is always present.

The more you watch something, the more familiar it becomes. The more familiar it becomes, the more acceptable it feels. And once something feels normal, it begins to shape your thinking.

This is how influence works quietly.

The Power of Repetition

One of the strongest tools media uses is repetition. When a message is repeated constantly, it begins to feel like truth. When an idea appears everywhere, it begins to look like reality.

This is why young people must learn to think critically.

Not everything trending is meaningful.
Not everything popular is healthy.
Not everything loud is right.

The ability to pause and ask questions protects your mind.

Why is this content being pushed?
What is it encouraging?
How does it affect my thinking?

A thoughtful mind is harder to mislead.

Identity and Comparison

Media often creates unrealistic standards. Perfect lifestyles. Perfect bodies. Perfect success stories. Perfect moments.

But what many people do not see is that most of what is presented online is edited, filtered, and selective. People show highlights, not struggles. They show wins, not failures. They show excitement, not reality.

When a young person compares their real life to someone else's edited life, insecurity grows.

You begin to feel behind.
You begin to feel not good enough.
You begin to feel pressured to perform.

This is why identity must not be built on media validation. Your worth is not determined by likes, comments, followers, or attention.

Your life is real, and real life grows gradually.

Information Overload

This generation has access to more information than any generation before. News, tutorials, opinions, stories, and updates flow constantly. While this is powerful, it can also be overwhelming.

Too much information without understanding can confuse the mind.

A young person may know many things but still lack direction. They may consume content all day but not grow internally. They may be informed but not transformed.

Wisdom is not about how much you know; it is about what you do with what you know.

Learning to filter information is important. Not everything deserves your attention. Not everything deserves your time.

The Responsibility of What You Consume

Everything you consume shapes you. The music you listen to affects your emotions. The videos you watch affect your imagination. The conversations you follow affect your mindset.

Your mind is like a garden. Whatever you plant repeatedly begins to grow.

If you constantly feed your mind negativity, fear grows.
If you constantly feed your mind distractions, focus weakens.
If you constantly feed your mind growth, maturity increases.

You must become intentional about what enters your mind.

Not everything is bad, but not everything is beneficial.

Becoming a Positive Voice

Media influence is not only about what you watch; it is also about what you share. Every post, comment, message, and video contributes to the environment around you.

You are not just a consumer; you are also a contributor.

You can spread encouragement.
You can spread truth.
You can spread knowledge.
You can spread hope.

Or you can spread negativity, pressure, and confusion.

Young people must begin to see media as a platform for impact, not just entertainment. Your voice matters. Your content matters. The energy you bring online matters.

Influence is not only for celebrities. It belongs to anyone who uses their voice responsibly.

Media and Emotional Health

Constant exposure to media can affect emotional health. Seeing others constantly succeed can create pressure. Exposure to negativity can create anxiety. Endless scrolling can create restlessness and lack of focus.

Many young people do not realize how deeply media affects their emotions.

It can drain energy.
It can distract purpose.
It can reduce attention span.

This is why balance is necessary.

Time away from screens.
Time for reflection.

Time for real conversations.
Time for personal growth.

Silence sometimes strengthens the mind more than noise.

Truth Versus Trends

Not everything that trends is truth. Media moves fast. Opinions change quickly. What is celebrated today may be criticized tomorrow.

A young person who follows trends without understanding may feel lost constantly. One moment they are trying to fit in, the next moment they feel left out.

Truth is steady. Trends are temporary.

Building your life on trends leads to confusion. Building your life on truth leads to stability.

Using Media for Growth

Media is not the enemy. It is a tool. And like every tool, it can build or destroy depending on how it is used.

Through media, you can learn skills.
Through media, you can discover opportunities.

Through media, you can connect with mentors.
Through media, you can share ideas.

It can be a place of learning, creativity, and expression.

But intentional use is required. You must decide what role media will play in your life distraction or development.

Digital Discipline

Discipline is necessary in the digital age. Without it, time disappears quickly. Hours go by scrolling, watching, reacting, and comparing.

Digital discipline means knowing when to log in and when to log out. It means choosing purpose over impulse. It means controlling media instead of letting media control you.

It means asking yourself:
Is this helping my growth?
Is this feeding my purpose?
Is this shaping my mind positively?

If not, adjustment is needed.

Influence Beyond Screens

Real life still matters. Relationships still matter. Growth still happens offline. Character still forms in daily living, not just online presence.

A person may be loud online but empty offline. They may appear confident online but struggle privately. Media should never replace real growth.

The strongest influence still comes from how you live, not just what you post.

Preparing to Shape Media

The future of media belongs to this generation. The voices shaping tomorrow are growing today. Young people who understand media deeply will not only consume it they will transform it.

They will tell meaningful stories.
They will share truth.
They will use platforms responsibly.
They will influence culture positively.

Media needs voices that carry purpose, wisdom, and clarity.

And that voice can be yours.

A Mountain That Shapes Society

Media influences culture. Culture influences behavior. Behavior influences society. That is why this mountain is so powerful.

What people watch affects what they accept.
What they accept affects how they live.
How they live affects the direction of society.

Understanding media helps a young person stay grounded while navigating a fast-moving world.

You learn to see beyond appearance.
You learn to question before accepting.
You learn to protect your mind.

And most importantly, you learn to use your voice wisely.

Becoming Intentional

The question is no longer whether media will influence you. It already does. The real question is how you will respond to it.

Will you allow it to shape you without direction?
Or will you use it as a tool to grow, learn, and influence positively?

Intentional living changes everything.

When you know who you are, media will not confuse you.
When you know your purpose, media will not distract you.
When you know your values, media will not control you.

You will stand firm while others are carried by every new wave.

This mountain is powerful, but it is not stronger than a focused mind, a grounded heart, and a clear purpose.

And every teenager and young adult who understands this becomes not just a media consumer but a voice of influence in a noisy world.

CHAPTER NINE: THE MOUNTAIN OF GOVERNMENT AND LEADERSHIP

The mountain of government and leadership is one of the most influential forces in society because it shapes how people live, how systems function, and how decisions affect entire communities. Even though many teenagers feel far removed from government, the truth is that leadership affects everyone directly or indirectly.

The rules in schools, the roads in communities, the opportunities available, the systems that protect people, and even the structure of society are all shaped by leadership. This mountain is not only about politics or public office; it is about responsibility, service, and the ability to guide people and systems toward a better direction.

For young people, understanding leadership early is important because leadership does not start when you hold a position. It starts with how you live daily. It starts with how you make decisions, how you treat people, and how you take responsibility for your actions.

Leadership is influence with responsibility.

Leadership Begins with Self

Before anyone leads others, they must learn to lead themselves. Self-leadership is the foundation of all leadership. It is the ability to manage

your time, control your emotions, stay disciplined, and make wise decisions even when nobody is watching.

A teenager who learns to lead themselves becomes different. They take ownership of their growth. They accept correction. They stay committed even when things are difficult. They begin to stand out naturally.

Many people want to lead others, but few are willing to discipline themselves. Without self-leadership, public leadership becomes weak.

True leadership begins in private.

Understanding Government

Government exists to provide structure and order in society. It creates laws, policies, and systems that guide how people interact and how resources are managed. Good leadership creates stability, opportunity, and development. Poor leadership creates confusion, inequality, and frustration.

Young people often feel disconnected from government because it seems distant or complicated. But government decisions affect education, security, health, job opportunities, and everyday life.

Understanding how leadership works helps a young person become aware, responsible, and prepared to contribute positively in the future.

Leadership is not just about criticizing systems. It is about preparing to improve them.

The Difference Between Position and Leadership

Holding a position does not automatically make someone a leader. Leadership is not about titles, recognition, or authority. It is about impact.

A person can hold a high position and still lack leadership. Another person can hold no title and still influence people positively.

Leadership shows in actions:

- Taking responsibility
- Standing for what is right
- Helping others grow
- Making decisions that benefit people, not just self

Positions give authority. Character gives leadership.

Service as the Heart of Leadership

At its core, leadership is service. It is the willingness to put people first, to listen, to understand needs, and to create solutions.

A young person who understands service begins to lead naturally. Helping others without expecting recognition builds humility. Supporting others builds trust. Being available builds connection.

Leadership is not about being above people; it is about being responsible for people.

When leadership loses the spirit of service, it becomes control. But when leadership is rooted in service, it becomes transformation.

Courage and Responsibility

Leadership requires courage. The courage to stand alone when necessary. The courage to speak truth. The courage to make difficult decisions. The courage to accept mistakes and grow.

Many people avoid leadership because of responsibility. Responsibility demands accountability. It demands consistency. It demands maturity.

But growth happens through responsibility. Every small responsibility prepares a young person for bigger roles.

Being reliable at home prepares you for reliability in society. Being responsible in school prepares you for responsibility in leadership spaces.

Leadership is built step by step.

Integrity in Leadership

Integrity is one of the most important qualities of leadership. It is the alignment between what you say and how you live. It is doing what is right even when it is not convenient.

People may listen to leaders because of authority, but they follow leaders because of integrity.

A young person who builds integrity early becomes trustworthy. People feel safe around them. People respect their voice. People value their decisions.

Integrity cannot be forced. It is built through consistent honesty, humility, and responsibility.

Leadership Among Peers

Leadership does not only happen in government offices. It happens among friends, classmates, and communities.

When you encourage others, you are leading.
When you support someone struggling, you are leading.
When you stand against bullying, you are leading.
When you influence friends toward positive choices, you are leading.

Peer leadership is powerful because it shapes environments where young people live daily.

Influence among peers can either build or destroy. It can promote discipline or distractions. It can encourage growth or unhealthy habits.

Young people must begin to see themselves as leaders in their spaces.

Decision-Making and Consequences

Leadership involves making decisions. And every decision carries consequences.

Learning how to think before acting is a leadership skill. Considering the impact of your choices, not just the immediate benefit, builds maturity.

A leader asks:
How will this affect others?
Is this right or just convenient?
What example does this set?

Decision-making shapes direction.

Preparing for Future Leadership

Not every young person will enter politics or public office, but every young person will influence people in some way. Some will lead

families. Some will lead organizations. Some will lead businesses. Some will lead communities.

Preparation begins now.

Through discipline.
Through learning.
Through character development.
Through responsibility.

Leadership is not a sudden event. It is a gradual preparation.

Leadership and Justice

A society grows stronger when leadership promotes fairness and justice. Leadership should protect the weak, create opportunities, and ensure that systems serve people, not exploit them.

Young people must understand the value of fairness early. Respecting others, standing against injustice, and promoting equality in daily interactions builds a mindset for responsible leadership later.

Leadership must always remember people.

Influence Beyond Power

Many people see leadership as power. But real leadership is influence beyond control. It is the ability to inspire people, to guide them, and to create positive change without force.

Influence built on fear fades. Influence built on trust grows.

A young person who leads with kindness, wisdom, and courage builds influence that lasts longer than authority.

Learning from Leaders Around You

Leadership lessons are everywhere. From teachers, parents, community leaders, and even public figures. Observing how people lead teaches valuable lessons.

You learn what works.
You learn what fails.
You learn what inspires.
You learn what damages trust.

Learning from others prepares you to lead better.

The Role of Young People in Nation Building

Young people are not just the future; they are part of the present. Their ideas, energy, creativity, and passion shape the direction of society.

When young people become responsible, informed, and intentional, society begins to change gradually. Leadership becomes healthier. Systems improve. Communities grow stronger.

Change does not start from the top alone. It starts from individuals who choose growth, responsibility, and service.

Leadership Rooted in Purpose

Leadership without purpose becomes empty. It becomes about control, recognition, and personal gain. But leadership rooted in purpose becomes meaningful. It becomes about impact.

When purpose guides leadership:

- decisions become intentional
- service becomes natural
- influence becomes positive

Purpose keeps leadership grounded.

A Call to Rise

Every teenager and young adult carries leadership potential. It may not look obvious now. It may not be fully developed. But it is there.

It shows in your voice.
It shows in your choices.
It shows in how you treat people.

Leadership is not waiting for you in the future. It is already growing inside you.

The way you live today is shaping the leader you will become tomorrow.

This mountain reminds you that your life is not just about personal success. It is about contribution. It is about responsibility. It is about leaving things better than you met them.

Government and leadership are not distant ideas. They are daily practices in how you think, how you act, and how you influence your environment.

And every young person who understands this begins to rise, not just as a follower of society, but as a builder of a better one.

FINAL CHAPTER: RISING WITH PURPOSE, POWER, AND INFLUENCE

Every journey must come to a point of reflection a moment where everything learned begins to connect and make sense. This is that moment.

From family to education…
From faith to media…
From leadership to identity…

Every mountain we have explored is not separate. They are connected. They shape how you think, how you grow, and how you influence the world around you.

Purpose gives direction.
Power gives capacity.
Influence gives impact.

And all three must grow together.

You Are Not Too Young

One of the biggest lies young people believe is that life will “start later.” That purpose will begin after school. That influence will come in adulthood. That power belongs to older people.

But growth starts now.

The way you think now matters.
The habits you build now matter.
The choices you make now matter.

You are not preparing for life you are already living it.

Every decision you make today is shaping the person you are becoming tomorrow.

Understanding Your Journey

No two journeys are the same. Some people discover direction early. Others take time. Some grow in supportive environments. Others grow through challenges. Some walk confidently. Others walk while still figuring things out.

And that is okay.

Purpose is not a competition. It is a discovery.

You don’t have to rush. You don’t have to compare. You don’t have to feel pressured to become everything at once. Growth happens step by step, lesson by lesson, experience by experience.

What matters is that you keep moving, keep learning, and keep becoming.

The Power Within You

There is something powerful inside every young person — potential. Potential to lead. Potential to create. Potential to build. Potential to inspire. Potential to change environments.

But potential must be developed.

Through discipline.
Through learning.
Through mistakes.
Through growth.

Power is not noise. It is capacity. It is the ability to stay focused, stay grounded, and stay committed even when things are difficult.

True power is quiet but strong.

Influence Is Already Happening

Many people think influence only belongs to celebrities, leaders, or public figures. But influence happens daily.

In your words.
In your actions.
In your friendships.
In your decisions.

Someone is always learning from you, watching you, or being affected by you even when you don’t realize it.

The question is not whether you have influence. The question is what kind of influence you carry.

Positive or negative.
Intentional or careless.
Purposeful or empty.

Your life is speaking.

Becoming Intentional

Living intentionally changes everything. It means choosing growth over comfort. It means choosing purpose over pressure. It means choosing discipline over distraction.

It means asking yourself daily:
Who am I becoming?

What am I building?
What kind of influence am I carrying?

Intentional living leads to meaningful growth.

You Will Make Mistakes

This journey will not be perfect. You will make wrong decisions sometimes. You will feel confused sometimes. You will fail sometimes. You will question yourself sometimes.

But mistakes are not the end. They are lessons.

Growth comes from learning, adjusting, and continuing.

Do not allow guilt to stop you. Do not allow fear to freeze you. Do not allow comparison to discourage you.

Keep moving.

Staying Grounded

As you grow in purpose and influence, staying grounded becomes important. Success can distract. Recognition can change people. Pressure can confuse direction.

Stay rooted in values.
Stay connected to faith.
Stay committed to growth.
Stay humble enough to keep learning.

Grounded people last longer.

The World Needs You

This generation carries responsibility. The world is changing fast. Systems are shifting. Culture is evolving. Voices are rising.

The world needs young people who understand purpose.
Young people who carry discipline.
Young people who think deeply.
Young people who influence positively.

Not just dreamers builders.
Not just talkers doers.
Not just followers leaders.

And you are part of that generation.

Your Story Is Still Being Written

No matter where you are right now confused, focused, struggling, growing, uncertain, or inspired your story is still unfolding.

You are not finished.
You are not behind.
You are not forgotten.

You are becoming.

Every lesson learned, every challenge faced, every decision made is shaping a stronger version of you.

A Call to Rise

This book is not just something to read. It is something to live.

Rise in your thinking.
Rise in your discipline.
Rise in your faith.
Rise in your identity.
Rise in your responsibility.

Let your purpose guide you.
Let your power develop you.
Let your influence impact others.

Do not wait for permission to grow.
Do not wait for the perfect moment.
Do not wait until you feel ready.

Start where you are.
Grow with what you have.
Become who you were created to be.

Final Words

You carry purpose.
You carry power.
You carry influence.

And as you understand these mountains and grow through them, your life will begin to make sense in ways you never imagined.

You are not ordinary.
You are not empty.
You are not without direction.

There is more in you.

And the journey to discover it has only just begun.

About the Book

Rising with Purpose, Power and Influence is not just a book. It is a wake-up call to a generation that is full of potential but sometimes confused about direction.

This book was written for teenagers and young adults who know deep inside that there is more to life than just going to school, getting a job, and surviving. It is for those who feel called to something greater but are still trying to understand what that "greater" really is.

In these pages, you will discover that purpose is not something you stumble into accidentally. It is something you grow into. You will understand that power is not about control or dominance, but about discipline, character, and inner strength. You will also learn that influence is not reserved for celebrities or leaders — every young person already carries influence, whether they realize it or not.

This book breaks down the mountains that shape society — family, education, faith, leadership, media, and more — and explains how young people can rise within them without losing their identity.

It is practical.
It is spiritual but balanced.
It is honest.
It is real.

Through personal experiences, reflections, and simple truths, Oluwamayowa Francis speaks like a friend who has walked through confusion, redirection, and self-discovery — and is still growing.

If you have ever asked:

- Why am I here?
- What is my purpose?
- How do I build real influence?

- How do I rise without losing myself?

Then this book is for you.

You were not created to live small.
You were created to rise.

AUTHOR'S PROFILE

Oluwamayowa Francis Daniel is a devoted follower of Jesus Christ, a dynamic teacher of God's Word, and a passionate voice committed to raising a generation that understands purpose, power, and influence. His ministry and writing focus on spiritual depth, personal transformation, leadership development, and intentional living.

With years of ministry experience, Oluwamayowa has consistently equipped believers with practical tools for spiritual growth, maturity, and breakthrough. His approach combines biblical insight, real-life application, and disciplined thinking, making his teachings both spiritually impactful and intellectually engaging.

He holds a degree in Computer Science Education, reflecting his unique ability to bridge spiritual principles with structured reasoning and modern-day relevance. This balance enables him to communicate timeless truths in ways that resonate with today's generation.

Oluwamayowa is the author of several impactful books, including:

- *Breaking Free* — a powerful guide to spiritual liberation and personal transformation.
- *The Man That Housed Legions* — a deep exploration of spiritual warfare, deliverance, and restoration.
- *Anointed Yet Destroyed* — a thought-provoking work examining the dangers of character failure despite divine calling.

Through these works, he has addressed themes of spiritual growth, inner healing, discipline, identity, and destiny. His writings have inspired readers both locally and internationally.

In his latest book, *Rising with Purpose, Power and Influence*, Oluwamayowa shifts focus toward equipping teenagers and young adults to understand their identity, develop character, build inner strength, and rise responsibly within the mountains of influence shaping society today.

Through writing, speaking engagements, mentorship, and ministry, his mission remains clear: to inspire, equip, and empower individuals to live purpose-driven lives and walk boldly in the fullness of their God-given calling.

DEDICATION

This book is first and foremost dedicated to Jesus Christ the Author of purpose, the Source of true power, and the Giver of lasting influence.

To every teenager and young adult who feels there is more to life than what they currently see.
This is for you.

To the young minds searching for identity.
To the young leaders fighting silent battles.
To the dreamers who refuse to settle.
To the ones who know they were created for something greater.

This book is dedicated to you that you may rise with clarity, grow with discipline, and influence your generation with purpose.

To my parent and mentor Pastor and Pastor (mrs) Sam and Funmi Agboola whose guidance, prayers, and sacrifices laid the foundation for my journey thank you for shaping my values and strengthening my faith.

And to every life that will be transformed through these pages, may you discover who you truly are and rise boldly into your calling.

— Oluwamayowa Francis